

Landlord Compliance Checklist — ACT

The obligations every rental provider must meet under the Residential Tenancies Act 1997.

Correct as at July 2026. General information only, not legal advice. Confirm current requirements with Access Canberra before relying on this checklist alone.

Section 1 — Bonds

- ☐ [] **Respect the maximum bond of 4 weeks' rent.**
- ☐ [] **Lodge the bond with the ACT Revenue Office** — within **2 weeks** if you're a private lessor, within **4 weeks** if you're using an agent.
- ☐ [] **Provide a receipt as proof of bond payment.**
- ☐ [] **Never claim fair wear and tear against a bond.**

Section 2 — Rent

- ☐ [] **Provide at least 8 weeks' written notice** for any rent increase.
- ☐ [] **Never increase rent within the first 12 months** of a tenancy agreement.
- ☐ [] **Know tenants can dispute an increase they consider excessive**, potentially through ACAT.

Section 3 — Condition Reports and Repairs

- ☐ [] **Complete entry and exit condition reports** for every tenancy.
- ☐ [] **Respond to repair requests promptly**, particularly heating-related issues given Canberra's climate — this is a genuinely higher-stakes habitability item here than in warmer states.
- ☐ [] **Keep thorough records** — photos, correspondence, receipts, and condition reports.

Section 4 — Tax and Financial Obligations

- ☐ [] **Understand you'll pay land tax on any ACT rental property**, since it's not your principal place of residence — this is separate from rates, which apply to all ACT properties.
- ☐ [] **Check your foreign ownership surcharge exposure** if applicable — a 7% surcharge applies to foreign owners.
- ☐ [] **Keep records for your tax depreciation schedule and annual land tax assessments.**

Section 5 — Disputes

- ☐ [] **Understand ACAT's role** in resolving tenancy disputes — bonds, rent arrears, property damage claims, and breach matters all fall within its jurisdiction.
- ☐ [] **Keep thorough documentation** for any matter that could end up before the Tribunal — condition reports, correspondence, and receipts are what determines most outcomes.

Quick Reference — ACT Landlord Compliance Calendar

OBLIGATION	DETAIL
Maximum bond	4 weeks' rent
Bond lodgement	2 weeks (lessor) / 4 weeks (agent)
Rent increase notice	8 weeks, none in first 12 months
Land tax	Applies to non-PPR rental properties
Dispute resolution	ACAT

© HouseHQ. General information only, current as at the date shown — not legal advice. Confirm current requirements with Access Canberra and the ACT Revenue Office before relying on this checklist for compliance purposes.